



# HTML Blocks

Styled HTML sections for Joplin notes, written in plain markdown.

---

|           |                                       |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| VERSION   | 1.0.0                                 |
| REQUIRES  | Joplin 3.0.0 or later (desktop)       |
| AUTHOR    | madusanka                             |
| PLUGIN ID | <code>com.madusanka.htmlBlocks</code> |

*Every preview in this manual is rendered by the plugin itself.*

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HTML Blocks adds a single markdown fence to Joplin. Between `!!! type` and `!!!->` you get cards, callouts, checklists, step sequences, timelines, stat tiles, grids and more - rendered in the note viewer, highlighted in the editor, and carried through to PDF and HTML exports. Notes stay readable as plain text, and nothing is stored in your note but the fence itself.

# 1 Installation

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1. **Open the plugin settings.** In Joplin desktop, go to *Tools* → *Options* → *Plugins*.
2. **Install from file.** Press the gear icon next to the search box, choose *Install from file*, and select `com.madusanka.htmlBlocks.jpl`.
3. **Restart Joplin.** The note viewer only picks up new content scripts on start-up.
4. **Check it worked.** Type the example from section 2 into a note and switch to the viewer.

**Upgrading from an earlier build?** Remove the installed copy first, restart, then install the new `.jpl`. Joplin caches the old manifest in your profile directory, so installing over the top can leave the previous version in place.

## 2 The fence syntax

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There is one thing to learn. Open with `!!!` and a block type, close with `!!!->`:

```
!!! callout_tip Keyboard shortcut
Press Ctrl+Alt+H to open the block picker.
!!!->
```

### Keyboard shortcut

Press Ctrl+Alt+H to open the block picker.

### The opening fence

Everything after the type is an optional title, rendered as inline markdown:

```
!!! card_green My title with bold in it
```

- The type must start with a letter. That is what stops `!!!->` from ever looking like an opening fence.
- Up to three spaces of indentation are allowed. Four or more makes it an indented code block, as in normal markdown.
- Types are case sensitive and use `snake_case`. Many have shorter aliases - see appendix A.

### The closing fence

Three spellings are accepted, so use whichever reads best to you:

```
!!!->      !!!<-      !!!
```

### Two fields per line

Steps, timelines, stat tiles and key/value tables split each line on `::`. Extra fields are joined back together, so a line may contain more than one separator.

```
!!! stats Two fields per line
99.9% :: Uptime
1.2s :: Load time
!!!->
```

#### Two fields per line

99.9%

Uptime

1.2s

Load time

### Grid cells

Grid blocks split on a line of three or more dashes ( `---` ) or plus signs ( `+++` ). Each cell is parsed as full markdown.

### Nesting

Blocks nest. The plugin counts opening and closing fences, so an inner block will not close the outer one.

!!! card indigo Outer card  
Cards can hold other blocks.

!!! callout\_tip  
Including callouts.  
!!!->

!!!->

### Outer card

Cards can hold other blocks.

 **Tip**

Including callouts.

## 3 Inserting blocks

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You never have to memorise an id. There are four ways in:

| ROUTE                 | HOW                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Block picker</b>   | Press <code>Ctrl + Alt + H</code> ( <code>Cmd + Alt + H</code> on macOS), or use the toolbar button. Filter by name, pick a block, press <i>Insert</i> . |
| <b>Tools menu</b>     | <i>Tools</i> → <i>HTML Blocks</i> lists every block, grouped by category.                                                                                |
| <b>Toolbar button</b> | The layer icon in the editor toolbar opens the same picker. It can be hidden in settings.                                                                |
| <b>Cheat sheet</b>    | <i>Tools</i> → <i>HTML Blocks</i> → <i>Insert cheat sheet</i> drops one example of every block into the current note - handy as a scratch reference.     |

**Selected text is kept.** If you have text selected when you insert a block, it becomes the block body instead of the placeholder. The title placeholder is left selected so you can type straight over it.

## 4 Settings

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Found under *Tools* → *Options* → *HTML Blocks*.

| SETTING                                 | DEFAULT | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Highlight blocks in the markdown editor | On      | Colours the fences and tints the lines between them while you edit. Reopen the note for a change to take effect. |
| Show the toolbar button                 | On      | Shows or hides the picker button in the editor toolbar. Restart Joplin for a change to take effect.              |

## 5 Block reference

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All 47 blocks, grouped by category. The right-hand pane of each entry is live output from the plugin, not a screenshot.

### 5.1 Cards

13 BLOCKS

Every card in this family uses the identical syntax - only the accent colour changes. Swap the id for any of the previews below.

#### ● Light blue card `card_light_blue`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! card_light_blue Card title
Card contents, in ordinary markdown.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

#### ALL 13 CARDS

##### ● `card_light_blue` also: `card_lightblue` `card_sky`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_blue`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_indigo`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_teal`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_green`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_light_green` also: `card_lightgreen` `card_lime`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_yellow`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

##### ● `card_orange`

Card title

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

● `card_red`

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**Card title**

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

● `card_pink`

**Card title**

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

● `card_purple`

**Card title**

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

● `card_gray` also: `card_grey`

**Card title**

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

● `card_dark`

**Card title**

Card contents, in ordinary markdown.

## 5.2 Callouts

10 BLOCKS

Callouts carry an icon and a built-in default title. Give them a title to override the default, or leave the fence bare and take the default heading.

● **Info** `callout_info`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! callout_info
A short admonition.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

**i** Info

A short admonition.

### ALL 10 CALLOUTS

● `callout_info` also: `info`

**i** Info

A short admonition.

● `callout_tip` also: `tip hint`

**💡** Tip

A short admonition.

● **callout\_note** also: **note**

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 **Note**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_success** also: **success done**

 **Success**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_warning** also: **warning caution**

 **Warning**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_danger** also: **danger error**

 **Danger**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_question** also: **question faq**

 **Question**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_example** also: **example**

 **Example**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_bug** also: **bug**

 **Bug**

A short admonition.

● **callout\_todo** also: **todo**

 **To do**

A short admonition.

## 5.3 Lists

7 BLOCKS

● **Style 1 - dot pills** `list_style1`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! list_style1 Deployment steps
Run the test suite
Build the archive
Upload to the store
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Deployment steps

- Run the test suite
- Build the archive
- Upload to the store

## ● Style 2 - numbered circles `list_style2`

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```
!!! list_style2 In order
Numbers are added for you
So you can reorder lines freely
Without renumbering anything
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### In order

- 1 Numbers are added for you
- 2 So you can reorder lines freely
- 3 Without renumbering anything

## ● Style 3 - check marks `list_style3`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! list_style3 Deployment steps
Run the test suite
Build the archive
Upload to the store
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Deployment steps

- ✓ Run the test suite
- ✓ Build the archive
- ✓ Upload to the store

## ● Style 4 - arrows `list_style4`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! list_style4 Deployment steps
Run the test suite
Build the archive
Upload to the store
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Deployment steps

- Run the test suite
- Build the archive
- Upload to the store

## ● Style 5 - boxed rows `list_style5`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! list_style5 Deployment steps
Run the test suite
Build the archive
Upload to the store
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Deployment steps

- Run the test suite
- Build the archive
- Upload to the store

## ● Style 6 - separated rows `list_style6`

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```
!!! list_style6 Deployment steps
Run the test suite
Build the archive
Upload to the store
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Deployment steps

Run the test suite

Build the archive

Upload to the store

## ● Checklist `list_check`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! list_check Pre-flight
[x] Version bumped
[x] Changelog written
[ ] Archive uploaded
[ ] Announcement posted
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Pre-flight

☒ Version bumped

☒ Changelog written

☐ Archive uploaded

☐ Announcement posted

## 5.4 Layout

6 BLOCKS

## ● Steps `steps`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! steps Installing the plugin
Download :: Grab the '.jpl' file from the
releases page
Install :: Tools > Options > Plugins > Install
from file
Restart :: Reopen Joplin so the viewer picks it
up
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Installing the plugin

1

#### Download

Grab the `.jpl` file from the releases page

2

#### Install

Tools > Options > Plugins > Install from file

3

#### Restart

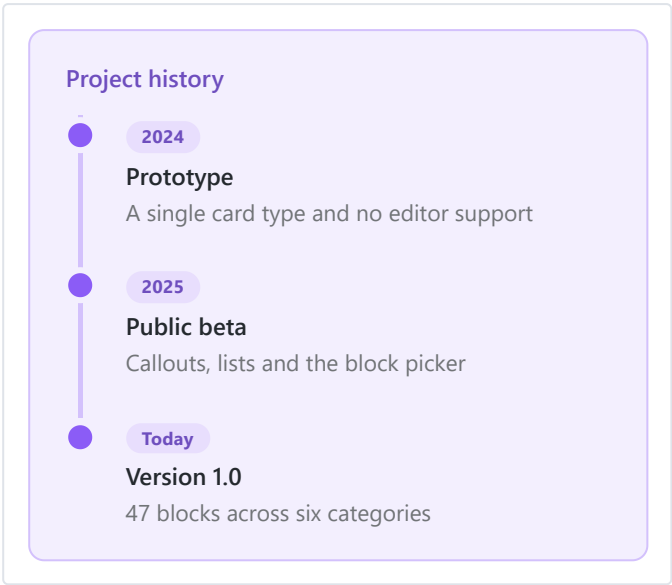
Reopen Joplin so the viewer picks it up

● **Timeline** `timeline`

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```
!!! timeline Project history
2024 :: Prototype :: A single card type and no
editor support
2025 :: Public beta :: Callouts, lists and the
block picker
Today :: Version 1.0 :: 47 blocks across six
categories
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

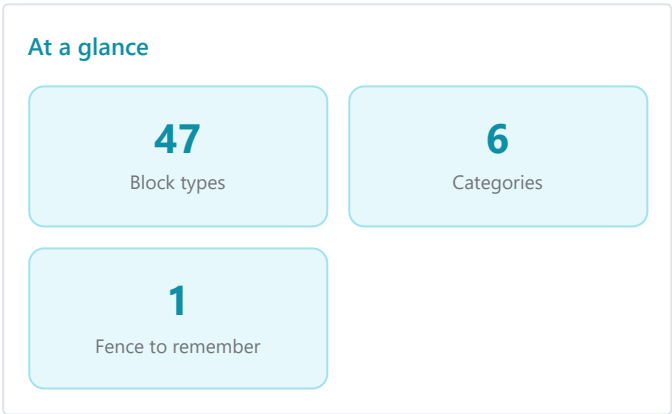


● **Stat tiles** `stats`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! stats At a glance
47 :: Block types
6 :: Categories
1 :: Fence to remember
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

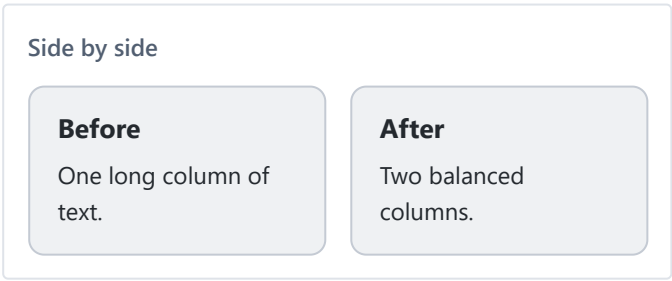


● **Grid - 2 columns** `grid_2`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! grid_2 Side by side
### Before
One long column of text.
---
### After
Two balanced columns.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS



## ● Grid - 3 columns `grid_3`

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```
!!! grid_3 Three across
### Write
Plain markdown
---
### Preview
Styled HTML
---
### Export
PDF and HTML
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

Three across

**Write**

Plain  
markdown

**Preview**

Styled  
HTML

**Export**

PDF and  
HTML

## ● Plain 2 columns `columns_2`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! columns_2
No frame, no heading - just two columns of text
sitting next to each other.
---
Useful when you want the layout without the box
around it.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

No frame, no heading - just      Useful when you want the  
two columns of text sitting      layout without the box  
next to each other.              around it.

## 5.5 Boxes

6 BLOCKS

### ● Plain box `box_plain`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! box_plain Plain box
A neutral container with a light border.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

**Plain box**

A neutral container with a light border.

### ● Dashed box `box_dashed`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! box_dashed Draft
The dashed border reads as provisional or
optional.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

**Draft**

The dashed border reads as provisional or optional.

## ● Shadow box `box_shadow`

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```
!!! box_shadow Raised box
A soft shadow lifts the box off the page.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Raised box

A soft shadow lifts the box off the page.

## ● Gradient banner `banner`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! banner Version 1.0 is out
Gradient banners are good for the top of a note.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

### Version 1.0 is out

Gradient banners are good for the top of a note.

## ● Hero section `hero`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! hero HTML Blocks
Styled sections for Joplin, written in plain
markdown.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

## HTML Blocks

Styled sections for Joplin, written in plain  
markdown.

## ● Highlight strip `highlight` also: `highlight_box`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! highlight
A thin strip for a single important line.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

A thin strip for a single important line.

# 5.6 Special

5 BLOCKS

## ● Quote `quote_box` also: `quote`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! quote_box Ada Lovelace
The Analytical Engine weaves algebraic patterns,
just as the Jacquard loom weaves flowers and
leaves.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

“

The Analytical Engine weaves algebraic  
patterns, just as the Jacquard loom weaves  
flowers and leaves.

— Ada Lovelace

● **Collapsible section** `details` also: `collapse` `spoiler`

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```
!!! details Show the full error log
Hidden until the reader clicks the summary bar.

    TypeError: cannot read property of undefined
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

▶ Show the full error log

● **Collapsible (open by default)** `details_open`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! details_open Already expanded
Same as the collapsible section, but it starts
open and the reader can fold it away.
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

▼ Already expanded

Same as the collapsible section, but it starts open and the reader can fold it away.

● **Badge row** `badges`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! badges Tags
markdown, joplin, plugin, css, no-dependencies
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

Tags

markdown joplin plugin css no-dependencies

● **Key / value table** `keyvalue` also: `kv` `fields`

YOU TYPE

```
!!! keyvalue Environment
Joplin :: 3.6.15 (desktop)
Plugin :: 1.0.0
Editor :: CodeMirror 6
Theme :: Follows Joplin
!!!->
```

JOPLIN SHOWS

| Environment |                  |
|-------------|------------------|
| Joplin      | 3.6.15 (desktop) |
| Plugin      | 1.0.0            |
| Editor      | CodeMirror 6     |
| Theme       | Follows Joplin   |

## 6 Behaviour worth knowing

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### Markdown inside blocks

Cards, callouts, boxes, quotes, collapsible sections and grid cells run their contents through Joplin's normal markdown pipeline, so anything you can write in a note works inside them.

```
!!! box_shadow Markdown still works
**Bold**, *italic*, `code`, [links]
(https://joplinapp.org)
```

1. Ordered lists
  2. Tables, images, footnotes
- ```
!!!->
```

Markdown still works

**Bold**, *italic*, `code`, [links](#)

1. Ordered lists
2. Tables, images, footnotes

### Line-based blocks

Lists, steps, timelines, stat tiles, badges and key/value tables read one item per line. Blank lines are ignored, and a leading `-`, `*` or `+` is stripped if you type one out of habit. Inline markdown still applies within each line.

### Unclosed blocks

A block with no closing fence runs to the end of the note rather than disappearing. That keeps the preview usable while you are still typing.

### Unknown types

A type the plugin does not recognise is not an error. It renders as a neutral box with the type shown as a badge, so a typo is visible rather than silent.

```
!!! card_turquoise Not a real type
Still rendered, with the type shown as a badge.
!!!->
```

Not a real type

card\_turquoise

Still rendered, with the type shown as a badge.

### Export and themes

Blocks are plain HTML and CSS, so they survive export to PDF and HTML. Colours are mixed against the current Joplin theme background, which means the same block reads correctly in both light and dark themes.

## 7 Troubleshooting

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| SYMPTOM                                                    | CAUSE AND FIX                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Please upgrade Joplin to version X to use this plugin"    | The installed build declares a minimum Joplin version newer than yours. This release requires 3.0.0. Remove the plugin, restart, and install the current <code>.jpl</code> . |
| Blocks show as literal <code>!!!</code> text in the viewer | The content script is not loaded - usually the plugin failed to start. Check <i>Tools</i> → <i>Options</i> → <i>Plugins</i> that it is enabled, then restart Joplin.         |
| Nothing renders after an update                            | Joplin caches content scripts. Restart the app; a full quit is more reliable than closing the window.                                                                        |
| No colour in the editor                                    | Editor highlighting is off, or the note was open before you changed the setting. Close and reopen the note.                                                                  |
| The block swallowed the rest of my note                    | A missing closing fence. Add <code>!!!-&gt;</code> where the block should end.                                                                                               |
| A block renders as a plain box with a badge                | The type is misspelled. Check the id against appendix A, or insert it from the picker instead.                                                                               |

# A Index of every block id

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| ID               | NAME                | CATEGORY | ALIASES                   |
|------------------|---------------------|----------|---------------------------|
| card_light_blue  | Light blue card     | Cards    | card_lightblue card_sky   |
| card_blue        | Blue card           | Cards    | -                         |
| card_indigo      | Indigo card         | Cards    | -                         |
| card_teal        | Teal card           | Cards    | -                         |
| card_green       | Green card          | Cards    | -                         |
| card_light_green | Light green card    | Cards    | card_lightgreen card_lime |
| card_yellow      | Yellow card         | Cards    | -                         |
| card_orange      | Orange card         | Cards    | -                         |
| card_red         | Red card            | Cards    | -                         |
| card_pink        | Pink card           | Cards    | -                         |
| card_purple      | Purple card         | Cards    | -                         |
| card_gray        | Gray card           | Cards    | card_grey                 |
| card_dark        | Dark card           | Cards    | -                         |
| callout_info     | Info                | Callouts | info                      |
| callout_tip      | Tip                 | Callouts | tip hint                  |
| callout_note     | Note                | Callouts | note                      |
| callout_success  | Success             | Callouts | success done              |
| callout_warning  | Warning             | Callouts | warning caution           |
| callout_danger   | Danger              | Callouts | danger error              |
| callout_question | Question            | Callouts | question faq              |
| callout_example  | Example             | Callouts | example                   |
| callout_bug      | Bug                 | Callouts | bug                       |
| callout_todo     | To do               | Callouts | todo                      |
| list_style1      | Style 1 - dot pills | Lists    | -                         |

| ID                              | NAME                          | CATEGORY | ALIASES          |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------|------------------|
| HTML Blocks 1.0.0 · User manual |                               |          |                  |
| list_style2                     | Style 2 - numbered circles    | Lists    | -                |
| list_style3                     | Style 3 - check marks         | Lists    | -                |
| list_style4                     | Style 4 - arrows              | Lists    | -                |
| list_style5                     | Style 5 - boxed rows          | Lists    | -                |
| list_style6                     | Style 6 - separated rows      | Lists    | -                |
| list_check                      | Checklist                     | Lists    | -                |
| steps                           | Steps                         | Layout   | -                |
| timeline                        | Timeline                      | Layout   | -                |
| stats                           | Stat tiles                    | Layout   | -                |
| grid_2                          | Grid - 2 columns              | Layout   | -                |
| grid_3                          | Grid - 3 columns              | Layout   | -                |
| columns_2                       | Plain 2 columns               | Layout   | -                |
| box_plain                       | Plain box                     | Boxes    | -                |
| box_dashed                      | Dashed box                    | Boxes    | -                |
| box_shadow                      | Shadow box                    | Boxes    | -                |
| banner                          | Gradient banner               | Boxes    | -                |
| hero                            | Hero section                  | Boxes    | -                |
| highlight                       | Highlight strip               | Boxes    | highlight_box    |
| quote_box                       | Quote                         | Special  | quote            |
| details                         | Collapsible section           | Special  | collapse spoiler |
| details_open                    | Collapsible (open by default) | Special  | -                |
| badges                          | Badge row                     | Special  | -                |
| keyvalue                        | Key / value table             | Special  | kv fields        |